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electrons around boron atom. Moving a lone pair from one of the fluorine to form additional bond as shown below.

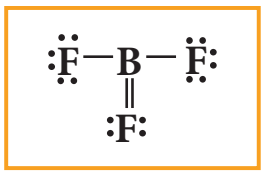


Fig 10. 8 (b) Lewis structure of BF_3

However, the above structure is unfavourable as the most electronegative atom fluorine shows positive formal charge and hence the structure with incomplete octet is the favourable one. Molecules such as BCl_3, $BeCl_2$, etc... also have incomplete octets.

Molecules containing odd electrons

Few molecules have a central atom with an odd number of valence electrons. For example, in nitrogen dioxide and nitric oxide all the atoms does not have octet configuration. The lewis structure of the above molecules are shown in the figure.

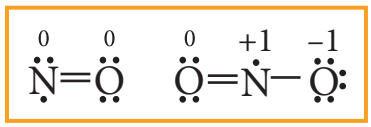


Fig 10. 9 Lewis structures of Nitric oxide and Nitrogen dioxide (with formal charges)

Molecules with expanded valence shells

In molecules such as sulphur hexafluoride (SF_6), phosphorous pentachloride (PCl_5) the central atom has more than eight valence electrons around them. Here the central atom can accommodate additional electron pairs by using outer vacant d orbitals. In SF_6 the central atom sulphur is surrounded by six bonding pair of electrons or twelve electrons.

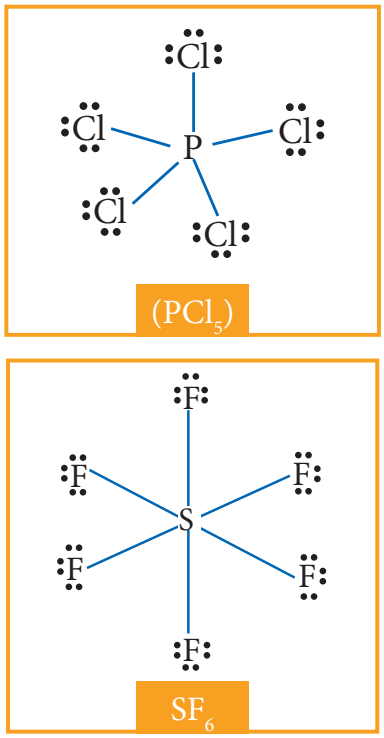


Fig 10. 10 Lewis structures for SF_6 and PCl_5

Evaluate Yourself

2) Calculate the formal charge on each atom of carbonyl chloride ($COCl_2$)

10.3 Ionic or electrovalent bond

When the electronegativity difference between the two combining atoms is large, the least electronegative atom completely transfers one or more of its valence electrons to the other combining atom so that both atoms can attain the nearest inert gas electronic configuration. The complete transfer of electron leads to the formation of a cation and an anion. Both these ions are held together by the electrostatic attractive force which is known as ionic bond.

Let us consider the formation potassium chloride. The electronic configuration of potassium and chlorine are